

ANCIENT HISTORY



MODULE - 12

MAHAJANAPADAS

PART-2

OUR APPROACH TO FIND HISTORY FROM MYSTERY?

PRE - HISTORY

The period of time before written records.

- Stone Age
- Metal Age

PROTO - HISTORY

IVC

Aryan Invasion

VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 500 B.C.)

EARLY VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 1000 B.C.)

LATER VEDIC AGE
(1000 – 500 B.C.)

RELIGION & PHILOSOPHY



JAINISM



BUDDHISM

HISTORIC PERIOD

MAHAJANAPADAS

TERRITORIAL EXPANSION

MAGADHA

NANDA DYNASTY

Alexander Invasion

MAURYAN DYNASTY

SANGAM AGE

MAURYAN DYNASTY

GUPTA DYNASTY

Foreign Invasion

KUSHAN EMPIRE

SATAVAHANAS

PUSHYABHUTHI DYNASTY

Huns Invasion

CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS

CHOLA

CHERA

PANDYA

MAUKHARIS

VAKATAKAS

KADAMBAS

ORIGIN OF MAHAJANAPADAS

MAGADHAN DYNASTIES

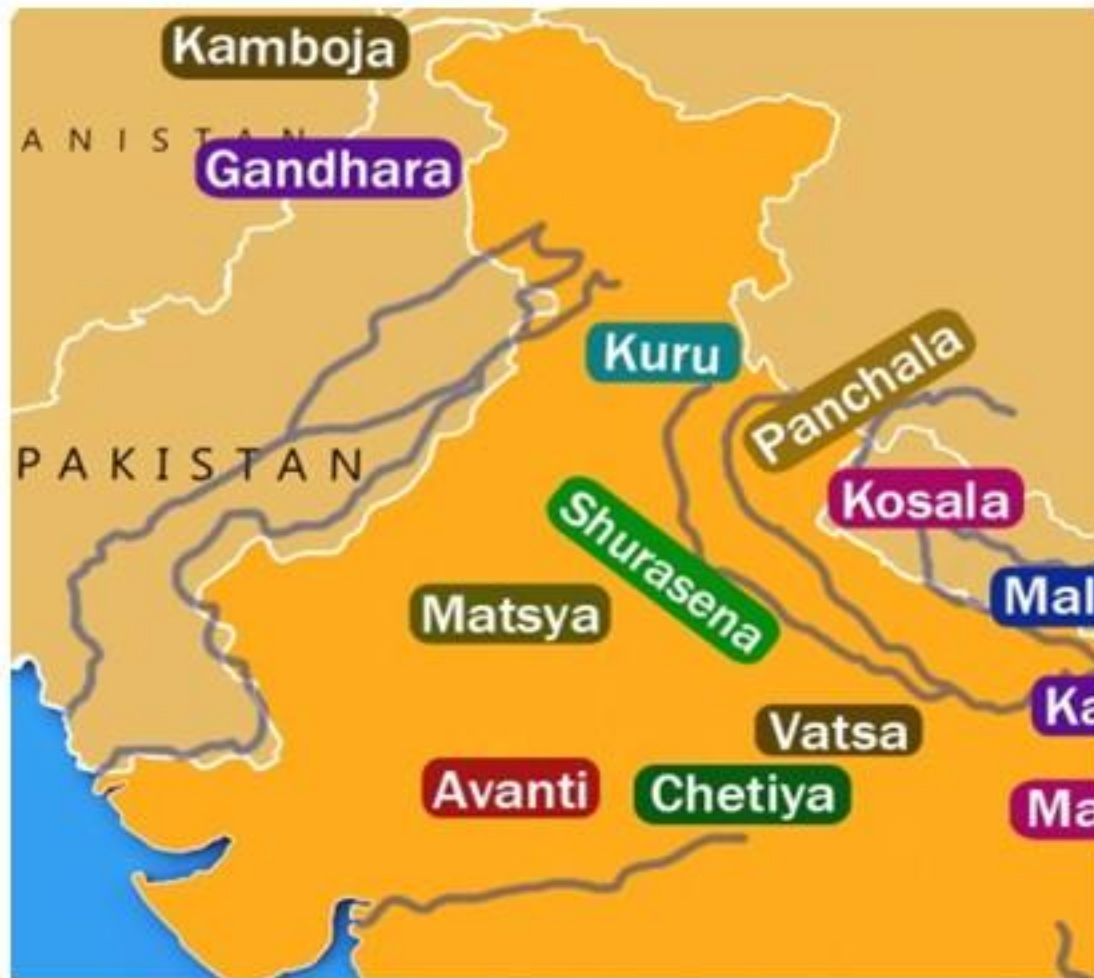
FOREIGN INVASION

PERSIAN AND GREEK IMPACT ON INDIA

FACTS ABOUT MAHAJANAPADAS

SITUATION OF NORTH-WEST INDIA

PERSIAN AND MACEDONIAN INVASIONS



Mahajanapads of north-west India like **Kamboja, Gandhara** etc. were continuously fighting

So powerful kingdom like Magadha could not emerge

Persian (Iranian) empire in the 6th century BCE penetrated into north-western India.

Taking advantage of this political disunity

SITUATION OF NORTH-WEST INDIA

PERSIAN AND MACEDONIAN INVASIONS

PERSIAN EMPIRE OR ACHAEMENID EMPIRE

- Achaemenid king, **Cyrus** (558–529 BCE) was the 1st ruler to invade the sub-continent.
- Persian king Darius, in 516 BCE, annexed Punjab, the west of Indus, and Sindh

MACEDONIAN EMPIRE OF GREEK

Till **Alexander's** invasion (around c. 330 BCE), the north-western part of the subcontinent was under Persian rule.



MACEDONIAN EMPIRE



SITUATION OF NORTH-WEST INDIA

ALEXANDER'S INVASION (327-326 BCE)



- 1 He was prince of Macedonia (Greece).
- 2 After decisively defeating the Persian army he entered the Indian provinces through the Khyber Pass in 326bBCE.
- 3 Except Porus, who fought the famous Battle of Hydaspas (on Jhelum river), all other kings submitted.

SITUATION OF NORTH-WEST INDIA

ALEXANDER'S INVASION (327-326 BCE)

WHY HE DID NOT MARCHED FURTHER EAST?



- 1 When Alexander reached Beas, his soldiers, being war-weary, homesick and diseased, refused to go further. Therefore, he was forced to retreat.
- 2 Alexander **fear** to advance further east due to **powerful Nanda dynasty**.
- 3 He placed a greek governor, **Selucus nicator** and retreated back.

MACEDONIAN EMPIRE



NANDA EMPIRE



SITUATION OF NORTH-WEST INDIA

ALEXANDER'S INVASION (327-326 BCE)

WHY ALEXANDER MARCHED TOWARDS INDIA?



ALEXANDER INVASION

1 Attracted towards India for its **fabulous wealth**.

2 Being a **passionate student of geographical inquiry** and natural history, he also wanted to **solve the problem of limits of the ocean**, which was a puzzle to Greek geographers.

4 **Zeal to conquer the world**.

3 Due to **weak small independent kingdoms** in north west there was no strong resistance.

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PERSIAN IMPACT ON INDIA

4 The monuments of Ashoka's time, especially the bell-shaped capitals and the preamble of Ashoka's edicts, have a lot of Iranian influence.

3 Rock inscriptions used by Ashoka in the 3rd century BCE were inspired by the Persian King Darius.

The 200 years of Indo-Persian contact resulted in not only political influence, but also socio-economic acculturation

PERSIAN IMPACT



1 It even gave impetus to Indo-Persian trade and commerce, hence forging cultural ties.

2 New form of writing came to be known i.e. Kharoshthi script was derived from Aramaic (the official script of the Persian empire, written right to left like Arabic) Some of the Ashokan inscriptions in north-western India are written in this script.

SITUATION OF NORTH-WEST INDIA

GREEK IMPACT ON INDIA

- 4** Crucial **socio-economic information** provided in these travelogues help us know
1. Diverse ancient societal **practices such as sati system**
 2. The **sale of girls** in market places by poor parents
 3. The **fine breed of oxen** in northwestern India



EFFECT OF ALEXANDER'S INVASION

- 1** First time Europe came into close and direct contact with ancient India
- 2** He exposed India to Europe by opening up four distinct lines of communication three by land and one by sea.
- 3** The clearly **dated accounts of Alexander's campaign** enabled Historians to build the **Indian chronology** for subsequent events on a definite basis.

SITUATION OF NORTH-WEST INDIA

GREEK IMPACT ON INDIA

8 Motivated the Mauryas to **believe** that capturing north-western frontier is feasible and a project worth undertaking.

7 **Indirect effect** of Alexander's invasion was that it **paved the way for unification** of north India under Chandragupta Maurya

EFFECT OF
ALEXANDER'S
INVASION



5 It paved the way for Greek **merchants and craftsmen** to establish trade between India and Greeks.

6 Another significant **cultural development** was the establishment of a **cosmopolitan school of arts at Gandhara**.

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AGE OF MAHAJANAPADAS

ARCHAEOLOGICALLY, 6TH CENTURY BCE IS MARKED BY

1

The **beginning of NBPW phase** (north black polished ware)

2

The **start of second urbanisation** in India (after the Harappan Civilisation).

3

This period marks the **origin of the Indian legal and judiciary systems**

AGE OF MAHAJANAPADAS

1 NBPW - PHASE



Bihar and Uttar Pradesh are the main regions of NBP ware sites

1. **Northern black polished ware** was characteristic of the urban centers of the **Gangetic Plain**, and is thought to have developed from the **technique of high-temperature firing** used in smelting iron and from the use of **hematite soil** locally available.
2. **It is a luxury product**, and the distribution helps the tracking of exchange and trade in different parts of the Indian subcontinent.

AGE OF MAHAJANAPADAS

1 NBPW - PHASE

- 2 Burnt bricks and ring wells appeared in the middle of the NBPW Phase.



People were aware of cementing material gypsum and mortar.

- 3 NBPW phase also marks the beginning of the use of money, as punch-marked coins- (which were the earliest coins called so as pieces of metals were punched with certain marks such as hill, tree, bull, fish, crescent, elephant, etc.) and made of silver, though a few copper coins are also found.



METAL MONEY

AGE OF MAHAJANAPADAS

2 SECOND URBANISATION



AGE OF MAHAJANAPADAS

2

SECOND URBANISATION

1

HIERARCHY OF SETTLEMENTS

RAJDHANI- CAPITAL CITY

MAHANAGARA

BIG CITY

PURA OR
NAGARA

FORTIFIED
TOWN OR CITY

NIGAMA- A
MARKET TOWN

INTERMEDIATE
LEVEL

GRAMA

1. All the major cities were situated on **river banks** and trade routes, and were connected with each other
2. These towns not only serve as **seats of government**, but they also served as major **hubs of trade and commerce** and were inhabited by many artisans and merchants who were organized into their respective guilds.

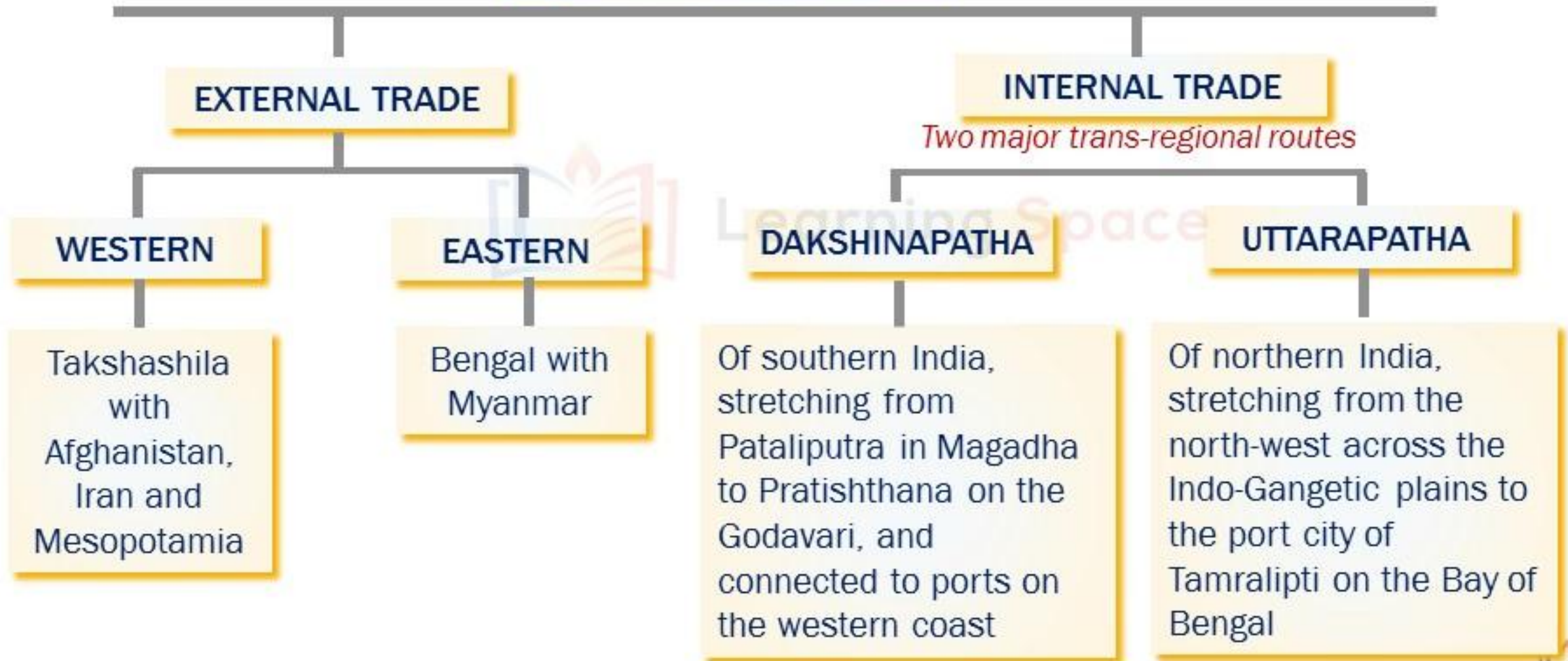
AGE OF MAHAJANAPADAS

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SECOND URBANISATION

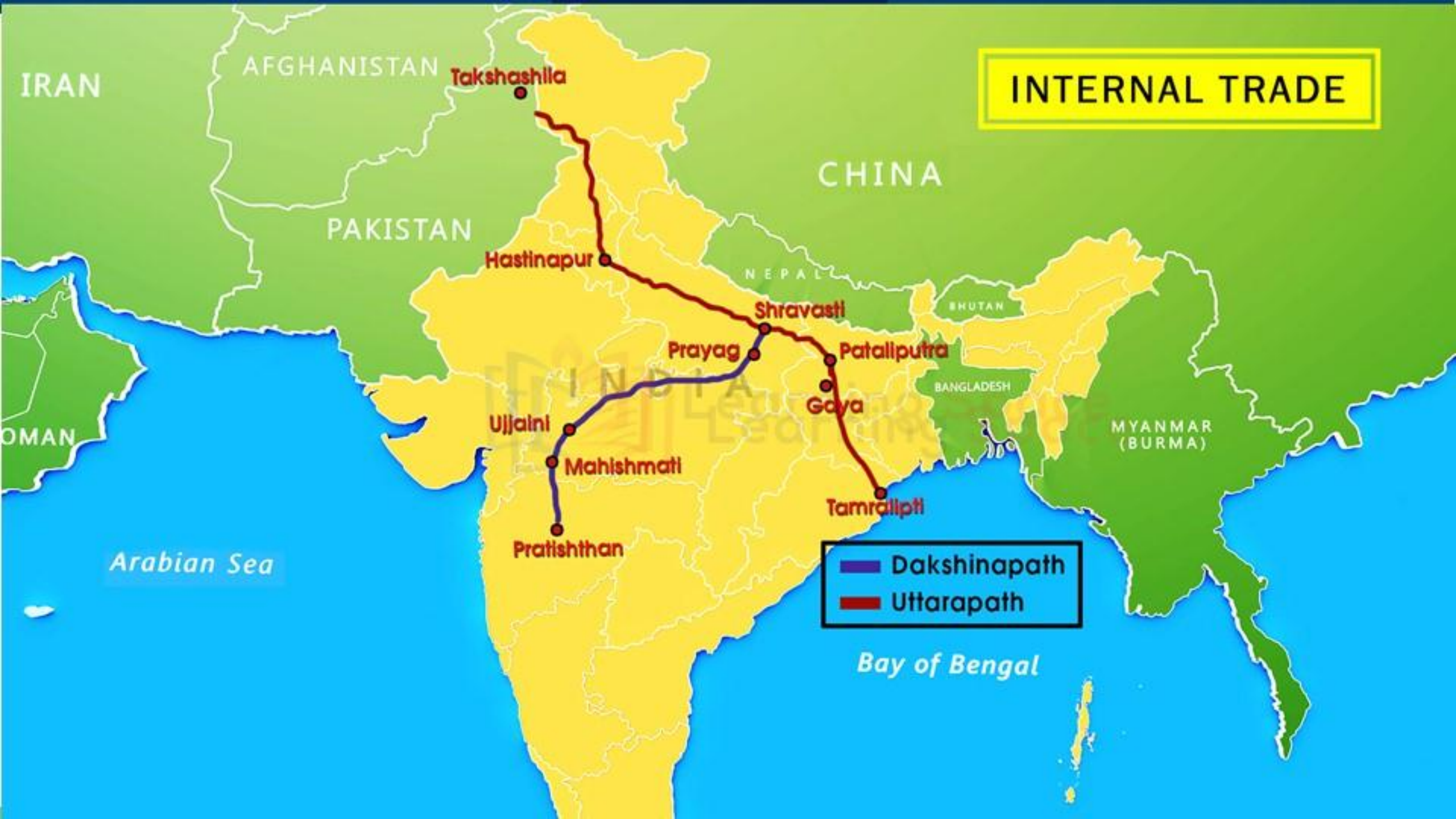
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TRADE ROUTES



EXTERNAL TRADE





INTERNAL TRADE

- Dakshinapath
- Uttarapath

AGE OF MAHAJANAPADAS

2

SECOND URBANISATION

3

TRADE AND COMMERCE

IMPORT

Included precious stones such as gold, lapis lazuli, jade, silver, etc.



LAPIS LAZULI



JADE

EXPORT

Finished **crafts** (like ivory products, pots), **textile goods**, **sandalwood**, and **pearls** were major items of export.



IVORY



PEARLS

Trade was facilitated by use of money termed **Nishka** and **Satamana**

AGE OF MAHAJANAPADAS

2

SECOND URBANISATION

4

FUNCTIONARIES

1

ARTISANS AND CRAFTSMAN

- Generally **crafts were hereditary**, and the son used to learn his family trade from his father.
- Panini's *Ashtadhyayi* mentions **wage (vetan)** and **wage-earners (vaitanika)**.

2

MERCHANT CLASS

- **Setthi** – a high level businessman, associated with trade and money lending.
- **Vessas** – merchant streets.

3

ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICIALS

- Custom officials (**Kammikas**)
- Toll officials who levied taxes on merchandise (**Shaulkika / Shulkadhyaksha**)
- Special royal officials called **Rajabhata**s were deputed to safeguard the lives and property of travelers.

AGE OF MAHAJANAPADAS

3 | LEGAL SYSTEM

THIS PERIOD MARKS THE ORIGIN OF THE INDIAN LEGAL AND JUDICIARY SYSTEMS

1

Since the *Varna* system were strongly entrenched in social life, the **legal system** was also partially disposed towards the *higher varnas*.

2

The *higher varnas* were considered **pur**er while all disabilities were imposed on shudras.

3

Crimes committed by Shudras against Brahmanas and others were punished severely, while **crimes committed** against shudras were punished lightly.

THOUGHT PROVOKING QUESTIONS

Q.1

Describe the effects of Persian and Macedonian invasion on India?

Q.2

What do you mean by second urbanization during pre- Mauryan times? Was trade a major factor in the second urbanization? If yes, then what were the major routes followed by traders and what were the general trading goods?

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CHALUKYAS

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MAUKHARIS

VAKATAKAS

KADAMBAS

CHOLA

CHERA

PANDYA

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